

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp

MONDAY, DECEMBER 15, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVI NO. 141

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

Last week: DJIA 48458.05 ▲ 503.06 1.05% NASDAQ 23195.17 ▼ 1.6% STOXX 600 578.24 ▼ 0.1% 10-YR. TREASURY ▼ 14/32, yield 4.194% OIL \$57.44 ▼ \$2.64 EURO \$1.1742 YEN 155.83

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **A breakout in transport** stocks has brought relief to investors who fretted that the outsize influence of tech in this year's rally could leave the market vulnerable to a downturn if a few heavyweights drop. **A1**

◆ **Ryder System's long-time** leader, Robert Sanchez, is retiring early next year as chief executive of the logistics and transportation company. **B3**

◆ **SpaceX executives** are starting the process to select Wall Street bankers to advise it on its IPO, with interested parties scheduled to make their initial pitches this week. **B1**

◆ **Chief executives** of some of the world's largest companies are all in on artificial intelligence, though many have yet to see meaningful returns on their investments, a CEO survey showed. **B4**

◆ **OpenAI told staff** that it was ending a compensation policy that required employees to work at the company for at least six months before their equity vests. **B1**

◆ **Charles Schwab CEO** Rick Wurster counseled prudence when approaching markets, telling The Wall Street Journal that there was a bright line between investing and gambling. **B2**

◆ **For the fourth time** in two years Armistice told investors who want to cash out that much of their money would likely be returned in the form of what are essentially IOUs. **B3**

◆ **A number of U.S.** companies have co-opted the word storyteller and applied it to vacancies they hope to fill in marketing, cybersecurity and other roles not traditionally associated with it. **B8**

World-Wide

◆ **Two gunmen killed** at least 15 people and injured more than three dozen during a Hanukkah event on Sydney's Bondi Beach, in what officials called a terrorist attack on Australia's Jewish community. **A1**

◆ **The attacker who killed** three Americans in an ambush on U.S. forces in Syria was a member of the Syrian security forces who was set to be fired for holding extremist views. **A1**

◆ **Trump's top envoys** held five hours of talks with Ukraine's president in Berlin as the U.S. steps up pressure on Kyiv to seal a deal with Russia on ending the war. **A6**

◆ **A Hong Kong court** convicted media tycoon Jimmy Lai of violating a national-security law in a case that could bring a life sentence. **A6**

◆ **A manhunt was underway** to find the shooter at Brown University who left two dead and nine injured. **A3**

◆ **Trump conveyed** uncertainty about whether Republicans would maintain control of the House in next year's midterm elections. **A4**

◆ **Israel's military** said it killed a Hamas commander in Gaza, the most senior military leader of the group to be killed there since a fragile cease-fire took effect. **A7**

◆ **U.S. officials** are seeking to recruit a multinational force of about 10,000 troops under an American general to stabilize postwar Gaza. **A7**

◆ **Chileans elected** as president hard-line conservative José Antonio Kast, who won easily after vowing to clamp down on crime and illegal immigration. **A8**

CONTENTS	Opinion..... A15-17
Arts in Review..... A14	Personal Journal A12-13
Business & Finance B2-8	Sports..... A18
Business News..... B3	Technology..... B4
Crossword..... A13	The Ticker..... B8
Heard on Street..... B9	U.S. News..... A2-5
Market Data..... B6	World News..... A6-10



© 2025 Dow Jones & Company, Inc. All Rights Reserved



GEORGE CHANG/GETTY IMAGES

Flowers were left Monday at Sydney's Bondi Beach, near where gunmen fired on a Hanukkah celebration. At least 15 people were killed and three dozen hurt in the Sunday attack.

Terror Attack In Australia Targets Jews

Two gunmen open fire on Hanukkah event in Sydney, killing at least 15

SYDNEY—Two gunmen killed at least 15 people and injured more than three dozen during a Hanukkah event on Sunday on Sydney's Bondi Beach, in what officials called

By Mike Cherney, Stuart Condie and Rhiannon Hoyle

a terrorist attack on Australia's Jewish community. One suspect was also killed, and the other is in critical condition.

It was the country's worst mass shooting in nearly 30 years.

"This attack was designed to target Sydney's Jewish community on the first day of Hanukkah," said Chris Minns, the premier of New South

Wales state, which includes Sydney. "What should have been a night of peace and joy celebrated in that community with families and supporters has been shattered."

Authorities haven't formally identified the shooters but said one of them was a 50-year-old man police shot and killed at the scene. The other shooter is his 24-year-old son, who was taken to the hospital under police guard. Police added that the older man had six firearms licensed to him.

Mike Burgess, who leads Australia's domestic intelligence agency, said one of the shooters in Sunday's attack was known to the agency but hadn't been considered an immediate threat. Police didn't say what ideology motivated the men.

Police said they located a vehicle near the attack site they believed held several improvised explosive devices, and a bomb-disposal unit was still on

Please turn to page A8

Syrian Who Killed U.S. Forces Was to Be Fired

By JARED MALSIN AND MICHAEL R. GORDON

The attacker who killed three Americans in an ambush on U.S. forces in Syria on Saturday was a member of the Syrian security forces who was set to be fired for holding extremist views, Syrian and U.S. officials said.

The attack illustrated the security challenges facing Syria's new president, Ahmed

al-Sharaa, a former Islamist militant who is trying to consolidate control over the country after the collapse of former President Bashar al-Assad's regime last year.

The incident also underscored the stakes for President Trump, who met with Sharaa at the White House in November and embraced him as a partner in combating Islamic State militants but faces new concerns about the Da-

mascus government's ability to screen its forces and new recruits.

Nour Eddin al-Baba, a spokesman for Syria's Interior Ministry, said in an interview with the country's national television service that the assailant had been suspected of extremist sympathies in an evaluation issued last week, and was set to be dismissed from the security forces on Sunday, the day after the at-

tack.

The attacker didn't hold a leadership role and wasn't part of the group that escorted a local Syrian security commander to a meeting with an American military official, Baba said. Syria is investigating whether the gunman had direct ties to Islamic State or if he simply adopted its ideology, he said late Saturday.

Initial information gathered by the U.S. also indicated that

the assailant had been a member of Syrian security forces who had been fired or was in the process of being removed because of suspected links to Islamic State, a U.S. official said.

Syrian security forces arrested five suspects in an operation in the city of Palmyra in

Please turn to page A7

◆ **Israeli forces kill a top Hamas figure in Gaza..... A7**

Chinese Amass U.S.-Born Babies Via Surrogates

20 boys to take over the business

Inside a closed Los Angeles courtroom, something wasn't right.

By Katherine Long, Ben Foldy and Lingling Wei

Clerks working for family court Judge Amy Pellman were reviewing routine surrogacy petitions when they spotted an unusual pattern: the same name, again and again.

A Chinese billionaire was seeking parental rights to at least four unborn children, and the court's additional research showed that he had

already fathered or was in the process of fathering at least eight more—all through surrogates.

When Pellman called Xu Bo in for a confidential hearing in the summer of 2023, he never entered the courtroom, according to people who attended the hearing. The maker of fantasy video games lived in China and appeared via video, speaking through an interpreter. He said he hoped to have 20 or so U.S.-born children through surrogacy—boys, because they're superior to girls—to one day take over

Please turn to page A10

Small-Town Museums Master The High Art of Memes

* * *

Institutions seek relevance by turning old paintings into stars of TikTok microdramas

By PATRICK COFFEE

"I love her, but she's an attention whore."

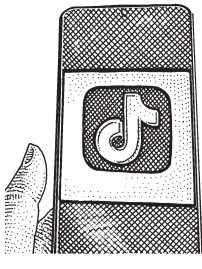
Poet Henry Wadsworth Longfellow appears to whisper this crass confession to his daughter in a popular TikTok post from Massachusetts' Worcester Art Museum titled, "what the paintings talk about when the Museum is closed."

That line never appeared in "Paul Revere's Ride," of course. It's a clip from the Hulu series

"Pen15" that became an audio meme on TikTok this summer. Zachary Critchley, who oversees the Worcester's digital media, saw it as a perfect opportunity to showcase both the 1869 portrait and the museum's personality.

"There's a reputation that museums, and particularly art museums, have of being kind of stuffy or like elitist or something like that, which is not something that I personally agree with," says

Please turn to page A13



Modern art

Two Killed in Shooting at Brown University



KYLE COOPER/REUTERS

SOMBER: The Brown University campus was in mourning after a shooting Saturday that left two dead and nine injured. Authorities on Sunday night were still searching for the gunman. **A3**

Transportation Stocks Rally In Bullish Signal for Economy

By KRYSTAL HUR

Transportation stocks are rallying, signaling investor confidence in the economy's outlook.

The Dow Jones Transportation Average, which tracks 20 large companies ranging from railroads to airlines, is up 10% this year and approaching a record high. The index re-

cently notched its longest winning streak since August 2020, according to Dow Jones Market Data, and in recent weeks has left the tech-heavy Nasdaq composite in the dust.

Shares of Delta Air Lines, Expeditors International and Ryder System are all up more than 15% this year and recently touched records. Avis Budget Group has risen 63%,

while C.H. Robinson Worldwide has gained 52%, Uber Technologies has climbed 41%, and Southwest Airlines has added 22%.

The transportation rally is a good sign, some analysts said. Airline, trucking and

Please turn to page A2

◆ **James Mackintosh: AI and dot-com bubble parallels... B1**

Christmas Music Is Humming Along

By ELIAS LEIGHT

The group Pentatonix are known for their a capella renditions of Christmas classics. They used to start touring after Thanksgiving, but this year they kicked off on Nov. 8.

"We're like, 'well, we don't know if somebody in Utah is

going to want to purchase a ticket for a Christmas concert on Nov. 8, but let's try it," said Sara Baczewski, who co-manages the group. Even starting so early, the 26-date arena tour has been going "super well," she continued. "The world is really looking for this."

Listeners are embracing Christmas music earlier than ever—and playing more of it. On Dec. 1, 2019, 14 holiday songs were in the top 50 on Spotify in the U.S. This Dec. 1, the tally was already at 30.

By Dec. 10, 20 of the top 25 tracks were Christmas-

Please turn to page A2